

MEET INDIA'S TEEN TITANS

From **match-winners** to quiet enforcers, here are the India U-19 players who shaped the World Cup and turned heads.

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Aaron George

Aaron George endured a string of middling outings in the U-19 World Cup, often throwing away his wicket after getting starts. But he broke that pattern when India needed him most. With 115 off 104 balls, George laid the platform for India to overhaul 311 against Afghanistan in the semifinal, the highest successful run chase in U-19 cricket, with nearly nine overs to spare. Back home, George has already led Hyderabad to the Vinoo Mankad Trophy, and his World Cup exploits are set to earn him a sustained place in the State's domestic outfits in the coming seasons.

M: 7 | Runs: 170 | Avg: 34.00



Vaibhav Suryavanshi

Vaibhav Suryavanshi single-handedly tilted the final in India's favour with a jaw-dropping 80-ball 175, laced with 15 fours and 15 sixes. It was the perfect culmination to a campaign in which he amassed 439 runs, the second-most in the tournament, and won the Player of the Tournament award. Notably, the last six players to claim this honour have gone on to represent their senior sides within three years. Suryavanshi was already a household name even before the U-19 World Cup, courtesy of his IPL exploits with Rajasthan Royals. With his prolific run in Zimbabwe, the 14-year-old has shown he can be banked on in crunch moments as well.

M: 7 | Runs: 439 | Avg: 62.71



Ayush Mhatre

Ayush Mhatre became the sixth player to lead India to an Under-19 World Cup title, joining a hallowed club that includes Virat Kohli and Mohammad Kaif. Mhatre started slowly, managing a solitary half-century against New Zealand in the group stage. But he rose to the occasion when it mattered most, contributing key runs in the semifinal and final against Afghanistan and England, respectively. His composure was the hallmark of his leadership through India's title charge, further boosting a rising profile that has already tasted success in domestic cricket with Mumbai and in the IPL with Chennai Super Kings.

M: 7 | Runs: 214 | Wkts: 7



Vedant Trivedi

Vedant Trivedi came to India's rescue when the more reputed pair of Ayush Mhatre and Vaibhav Suryavanshi misfired against Pakistan in the Super Six round. With its arch-rival snapping at its heels for a semifinal spot, India was cornered at 47 for three. Trivedi then steered the team out of trouble with a crucial 68 on a sluggish wicket, where the next-best individual score was 35. He helped India reach 252, which proved enough to shut the door on Pakistan and its hopes of reaching the semifinals at India's expense.

M: 7 | Runs: 135 | Avg: 27.00